The Plane Truth

By Ellen DeGeneres

ACTOR 1: **(Pg 28-34)** I know that the experts say you're more likely to get hurt crossing the street than you are flying

ACTOR 2: (these, of course, would be the street-crossing experts),

ACTOR 1: but that doesn't make me feel any less frightened of flying.

ACTOR 2: If anything, it makes me **more** afraid of crossing the street. As soon as the light turns green, I run across the street as fast as I can, screaming like a mad *person.* *(Actor 1 demonstrates)* I arrive on the other side out of breath, wheezing, and clutching my stomach.

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *Many people have a fear of flying*
ACTOR 2: *And the Flight Attendant's spiel before take-off doesn't inspire a great deal of confidence either!*
(Presented in friendly, flight attendant voices with accompanying gestures)
ACTOR 1: *Welcome aboard Flight 245. To operate your seat belt, insert the metal tab into the buckle, and pull tight.*
ACTOR 2: *It works just like every other seat belt, and if you don't know how to operate one, you probably shouldn't be out in public unsupervised.*
ACTOR 1: *In the event of a sudden loss of cabin pressure, masks will descend from the ceiling.*
ACTOR 2: *Stop screaming, grab the mask, and pull it over your face.*
ACTOR 1: *If you have a small child traveling with you, secure your mask before assisting with theirs.*
ACTOR 2: *If you are traveling with more than one small child, pick your favorite.*
TOGETHER: *The Plane Truth by Ellen DeGeneres*

ACTOR 1: I felt edgy the moment I stepped into the aircraft. That could be why I snapped at the woman in front of me. In my defense, she **did** ask the flight attendant a pretty stupid question:

ACTOR 2 as WOMAN IN 27-B (also a nun): Excuse me, where is seat 27-B?

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ACTOR 1: I mean, really. But I see now that I overreacted when I screamed at her, "Well, moron you walk in the only direction you can, and it's the 27th row seat B – next to seat A. All righty?!"

ACTOR 2: That sort of response is probably one of the many reasons why I'm not a flight attendant.

ACTOR 1: It was only when the woman (27-B) turned around to look at me that I saw she was a nun. *(Actor 2 makes the sign of the cross or praying gesture)* I guess that sort of hat-like thing she wore on her head should have given me a clue.

ACTOR 1: I tried to apologize by smiling and giving her a playful punch on the arm to let her know I was joking.

ACTOR 2: Well, either my playful punch carried more of a wallop than I intended,

ACTOR 1: Or her advanced years made her frailer than she appeared, but the nun shouted out

ACTOR 2 as WOMAN IN 27-B (also a nun): Owww! *(rubbing her arm in pain . . . she rolls up her sleeve)*

ACTOR 1: . . . you know, that bruise **could** easily have been there before I hit her.

ACTOR 2: My good friend Jasmine told me that a good way to combat fear is to chant.

ACTOR 1: *(making her way down the airplane aisle)* I'm going to die, I'm going to die, oh sweet Lord, I'm going to die.

ACTOR 2: It didn't work. If anything, I was **more** petrified when I got to my seat (27-A).

ACTOR 1: Even seeing the familiar face of the nun in 27-B *(Actor 2 at the nun looks up aghast)* didn't call me down. So here I am, sitting in my seat. *(taking calming breaths, then reacts violently to a sound)* ARGHHH! What was that? We're going to crash!!! *(Actor 2 as the nun responds)* Oh . . . It was just the beverage cart. Pardon me, Sister, I am sorry, I . . . I was frightened. Pray for me. *(Actor 2 as the nun give a hateful look and reaches to turn on the air vent)* Now she's going to turn on that little air thing above her. Maybe I'm paranoid, but I think it takes power away from the plane somehow. Sister, don't use that, that's . . . . Dang! Shut if off! Shut it off! *(Actor 2 as the nun has had enough. She climbs*

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over her seatmate to find another seat, turning to give a rude gesture) Some people are so touchy. I'm sure she didn't learn that little hand gesture in her convent, either.

ACTOR 2: I've got to relax somehow. Why didn't I think of this sooner? I'll recline my seat. *(both Actors do so)*

ACTOR 1: Oh, that makes all the difference. That ¾ of an inch between upright and reclined is the difference between agony and ecstasy. I never thought ¾ of an inch could mean so much.

ACTOR 2: When I get home, I'm going to put some gizmo in my chairs so that they go back ¾ of an inch, too.

ACTOR 1: But . . . I'd better not get too comfortable in my ¾-of-an-inch recline because toward the end of the flight, the flight attendant is going to say,

ACTOR 2 as FLIGHT ATTENDANT: You're going to have to put your seat in the upright position for landing.

ACTOR 1: They're so adamant about that every single time, like that's gonna make a difference. Because if we crash, the investigators are going to say,

ACTOR 2 as INVESTIGATOR: Oh, that's a shame, her seat was reclined ¾ of an inch. When will they learn? What was that – 30,000 feet? She could have made that. Sheesh. If only she'd been upright.

ACTOR 1: Being reclined isn't working. I'm still freaking out. I know what I need. *(Calling out)* Oh, flight attendant. Oh ma'am. *(to audience)* You have to talk nice to the flight attendants because they all have this attitude.

ACTOR 2: And they can afford to have the attitude, because they have the power – they have the peanuts.

ACTOR 1: They have these six peanuts that we need. Six peanuts. Somebody could offer that to you on the street, and you'd say,

ACTOR 2: I don't want that – get that away from me. Six peanuts? No- oh.

ACTOR 1: Somehow they've done research. They know that the higher we go, the more we need nuts. And we go crazy if we don't get them.

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ACTOR 2: Miss, I didn't get my, uh - - my peanuts. And I'd really appreciate it if you gave me some. *(stuffing peanuts one at a time in her mouth)* They're good, aren't they? I've never been able to get them on the ground either. At least not ones this good! *(licking the salt from her fingers)*

ACTOR 1: *(panicked)* What was that! We're going to crash! Oops, false alarm. It's just the food cart coming down the aisle.

ACTOR 2: Oh, here comes the cart, put down the tray! La la la la. Put down your tray! They're starting on the other side first. Hurry! Hurry! Those people over there – they're eating. Those people are eating.

ACTOR 1: Any kind of meat that you get – chicken, steak, anything – has grill marks on each side, like somehow, we'll actually believe there's an open-flame grill in the front of the plane

ACTOR 2: And salads are always two pieces of dead lettuce and salad dressing that comes in that astronaut package. *(package explodes as she tries to open it)* As soon as you open it, it's on your neighbor's lap.

ACTOR 1: Could I just dip my lettuce, ma'am? Hm, that's a lovely skirt. What is that, silk?

ACTOR 2: But you know, should that happen, club soda's gonna get that stain out immediately. That's the answer to anything you ask up there, I don't know if you've noticed that.

ACTOR 1: Excuse me, I have an upset stomach.

ACTOR 2 as FLIGHT ATTENDANT: Club soda, be right back.

ACTOR 1: Excuse me, I spilled something.

ACTOR 2 as FLIGHT ATTENDANT: Club soda, be right back.

ACTOR 1: Ooh, the wing is on fire!

ACTOR 2 as FLIGHT ATTENDANT: Club soda, be right back.

ACTOR 1: I thought the food would make me feel less frightened. But it didn't. Maybe if I stretch my legs and go to the restroom it will help.

ACTOR 2: You have no concept of time when you're in there – it's like a casino: no windows, no clocks.

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ACTOR 1: I could be the only one to get up out of my seat to go to the bathroom – everybody else is sound asleep when I go – but after I've been in there for what I think is thirty seconds, I open the door and everyone in the plane is lined up, looking at their watches, make me feel like I've been in there forever.

ACTOR 2: And now I've got to explain the smell that was in there **before** I went in there.

ACTOR 1: Oh! Listen, there's an odor in there and I didn't do it. It's bad. You might want to sprinkle some club soda, if you uh . . .

ACTOR 1: I think my only hope of escaping my mind-numbing fear is to sleep;

ACTOR 2: . . . to sleep and perchance to dream. . .

ACTOR 1: The only trouble is when I fall asleep on a plane, *(both drift off while finishing this statement)* I always have a nightmare . . .

TOGETHER: *(only to jolt awake screaming)* Oh sweet Lord, I'm going to die!

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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